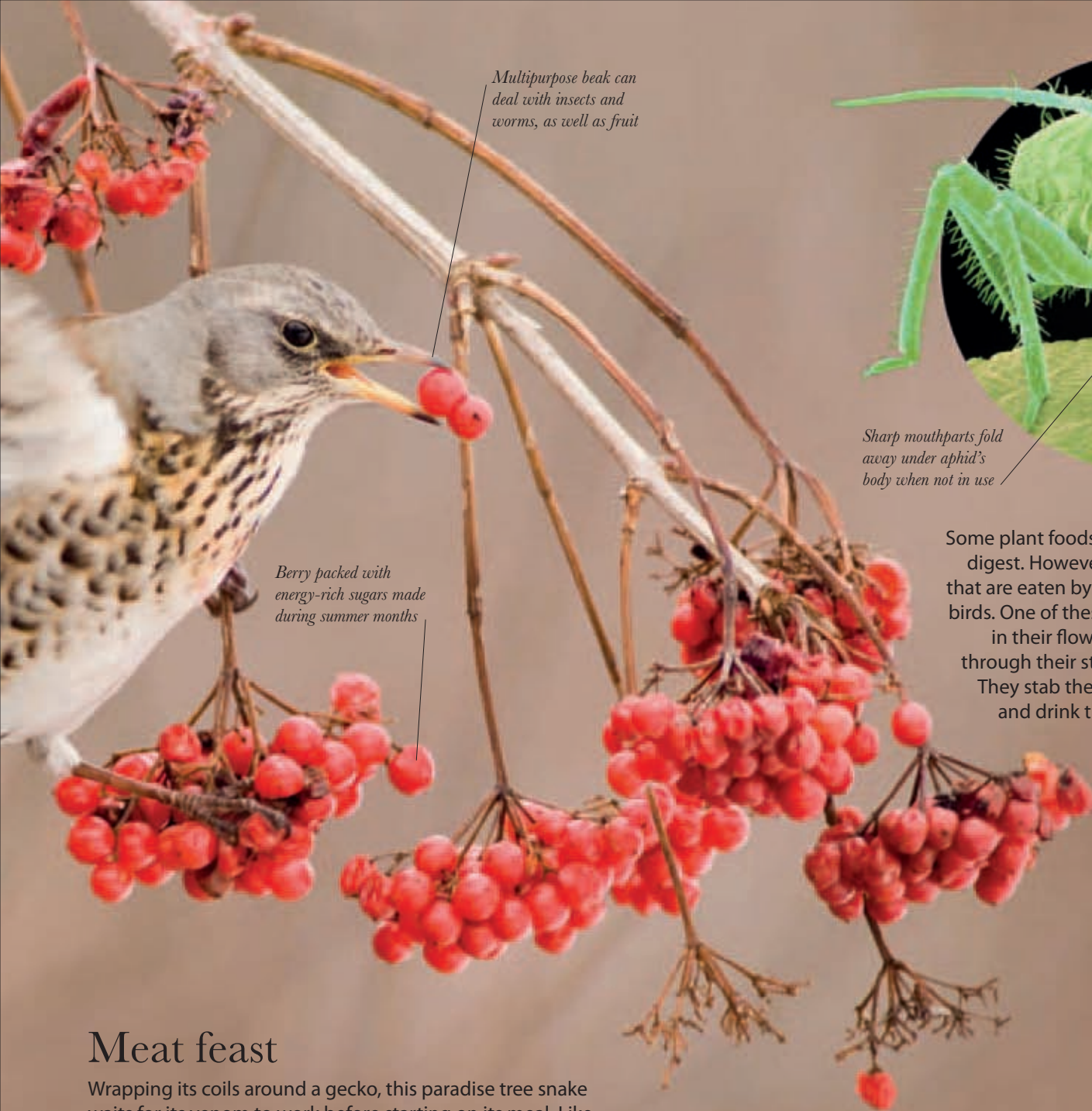


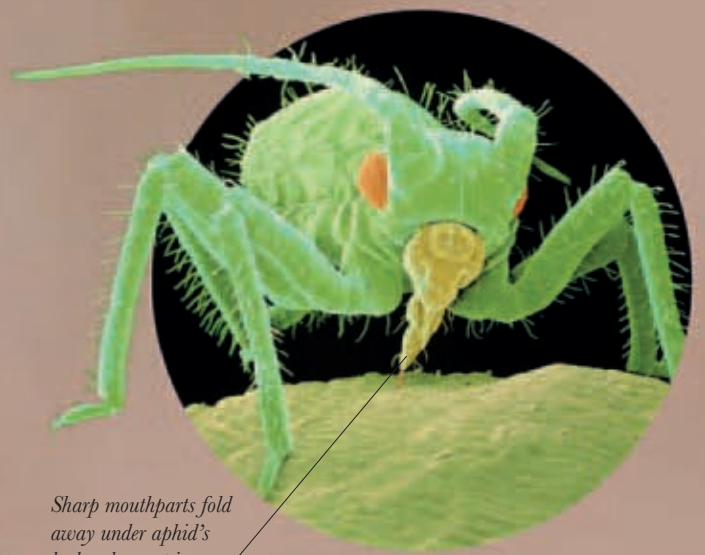


*Multipurpose beak can deal with insects and worms, as well as fruit*

*Berry packed with energy-rich sugars made during summer months*

## Meat feast

Wrapping its coils around a gecko, this paradise tree snake waits for its venom to work before starting on its meal. Like many predators, the snake uses stealth to track down its prey and strikes before its victim has a chance to escape. Hunting takes time, and it can be dangerous work, but successful predators reap the benefits. Meat is packed full of energy and nutrients, so meat-eaters need fewer meals than plant-eaters to keep themselves well fed.



*Sharp mouthparts fold away under aphid's body when not in use*

## Fluid food

Some plant foods are tough to eat and even harder to digest. However, plants also produce sugary liquids that are eaten by many animals, including insects and birds. One of these fluids is nectar, which plants make in their flowers, and another is sap, which travels through their stems. Aphids specialize in eating sap. They stab the stems with their hollow mouthparts and drink the sap as it oozes out from the plant.

## Constant gardeners

Animals don't always feed directly on the food they gather. Leafcutter ants carry pieces of leaf down from the treetops into their nests underground. Here, the ants use the leaves to make compost gardens, where they cultivate a special fungus. The ant colony feeds on the fungus and makes sure that it has the right conditions to grow. When a queen ant flies off to start a new nest, she carries some of the fungus food with her.



*Worker ant carries a piece of leaf back to nest*